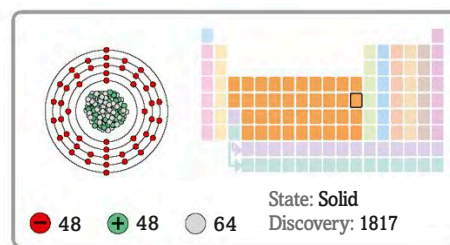


48
Cd

Cadmium



Forms

This mineral contains a rare form of cadmium sulfide, a compound of cadmium and sulfur.

This soft metal has a bluish tinge.

Pellet of pure cadmium refined in a laboratory

The yellow colour of this zinc mineral is due to cadmium impurities.

Greenockite

Smithsonite

Uses

Nickel-cadmium battery

Cadmium and nickel layers create electricity in this rechargeable battery.

This deep red pigment contains powdered cadmium oxide.

Red paint containing cadmium

This electronic component used in circuits contains a compound of cadmium and sulfur.

Light-sensitive resistor

Cadmium-covered screws do not rust.

Cadmium-plated screws

This research sample is being viewed under ultraviolet (UV) light produced by a cadmium laser.

Fluorescent microscope

Cadmium is a highly toxic metal, and is known to cause cancer. This rare element is found in the ore **greenockite**, but it is mostly obtained as a by-product of zinc extraction. **Cadmium** was discovered in 1817 from a mineral called calamine. Today, this metal is

mainly used in conjunction with nickel in **rechargeable batteries**. The compound cadmium oxide was once used in preparing **red paints**, but not anymore because of its toxicity. Cadmium is also used to create lasers for use in powerful **microscopes**.